

RAIN WORLD

You don't need good graphics. Good gameplay can carry a game too

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Sometimes, even though a game's graphics are good, the game is not. A really good storyline, or good gameplay can easily outsell the graphics of a game. Which goes to prove that graphics aren't EVERYTHING in a game.

Rain World is a 2D pixel art platformer game which was released back in 2017. When it was released, critics bashed it and it got very bad reviews. Today, Rain World is sitting on "Very Positive" reviews on Steam, and an 8.6 score on Metacritic. Did something change, or were critics simply being shallow? Let's find out.

STORY

The backstory of Rain World is pretty simple. You're a cute family of slug cats (we don't actually know what they're called but everyone else seems to be calling them that) traveling through the city. Suddenly the rain starts and everyone runs for shelter. But the rain proves to be a lot more dangerous. Suddenly, you find yourself slipping and falling down into

the sewers leaving all of your family behind. Your mission now is to get reunited with your loved ones.

We didn't really find the backstory to be compelling and motivating enough. Sure, getting separated from your family is cruel and all but it didn't really motivate us enough to get up and complete the game. It was the gameplay that did that.

GAMEPLAY

To put it simply, Rain World's gameplay is cruel. It's just cruel. Everything is out to kill you. You're literally at the bottom of the food chain. You can eat the flies and the fruits around you but everything else can eat you.

You enter the world in one of the few "waterproof" hibernation chambers. Each time you get out of that chamber, a cycle starts. During the tenure of the cycle, you need to explore the world around you, find new chambers and find "karma symbols" (we'll get to them later). The main thing here is that each cycle only has a limited amount of time which can be seen at the bottom of

your screen. Before that clock is up, you ABSOLUTELY NEED to go back into the waterproof chamber. Each time that timer is up, the place that you're in starts filling up with water as heavy rains start pouring down.

Each time you go into hibernation, you lose some energy points. These are small circles that you see besides the timer. If you have no energy points, the waterproof chamber won't even close. If it doesn't close, you die. Hence, the game FORCES you to go out and explore since the only way you can gain energy points is by eating various insects and fruits. This too, comes at a cost. Even if you find a cosy spot on the map which is coincidentally close to a hibernation chamber and food source, you still won't be able to survive for long. Food takes a couple of cycles to regenerate. Hence, if you pick the fruits from one place and eat them, in the next cycle, they won't be there again. This indirectly forces you to get out of your comfort zone and explore more.

Coming to the karma symbols. The game actually punishes you for